

Fast-Growth & Fundraising

We've taken a look at startups that secured their first round of VC funding, to identify indicators that a company is looking for venture capital.

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In this free report on startups likely to be seeking VC investment, you'll uncover:

The number and amount of first-time VC deals in 2021

What recipient companies have in common in terms of:

stage of evolution

previous equity funding rounds

previous financials

Four ambitious UK businesses likely to be fundraising with VC firms right now

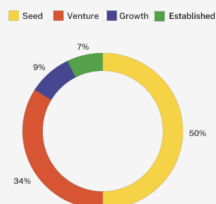
Stage of evolution

When raising their first round with a PE/VC fund this year, 50% of investee companies were operating at the seed stage. This means they were young businesses, with a relatively low employee count and valuation, little to no investment secured, and an uncertain product-market fit.

Meanwhile, around a third (34%) were operating at the venture stage at the time of their first PE/VC deal — companies with an established business model and revenue streams that have likely been around for several years, and may be expanding their initial product or service range.

Given that PE/VC funds tend to invest in earlier-stage companies, it comes as no surprise to find that seed and venture-stage startups were by far the most common recipients of first-time venture funding.

Company stage of evolution at time of first PE/VC-backed deal



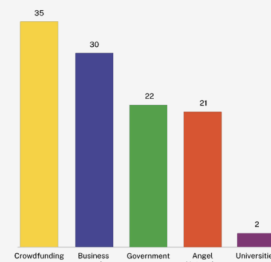
Existing investors

Where the funds involved were disclosed, 46 of these previous equity deals saw participation from angel investors, including both individual angels (30) and networks (21).

But crowdfunding platforms were the most common single source of funding, facilitating 35 rounds secured by businesses prior to their first-time PE/VC raise in 2021. This method of fundraising for early-stage startups with an engaged customer base has become increasingly popular over the past decade.

These figures show that early investors in high-growth companies are often individuals rather than institutions. But whilst angel investing and crowdfunding is used to develop a proof of concept or minimum viable product, ambitious businesses often need the investment of PE/VC funds to then reach the next stage in their growth journeys.

Fund types involved prior to first PE/VC investment



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35,022 companies found

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Name	Sector	Head office	Stage of Evolution	Status	Added
 Zopa	Consumer Banking...	London	Established	Active	25/10/21

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